

EDUCATION

University of Washington · Exp June 2027
Ph.D. Human-Centered Design and Engineering
Concentration: *Human-Computer Interaction*
Seattle, WA

University of Washington · 2025
M.S. Human-Centered Design and Engineering
Seattle, WA

University of Virginia · 2022
M.S. Systems Engineering
Charlottesville, VA

Virginia Tech · 2018
B.S. Mechanical Engineering
Minor: Green Engineering
Blacksburg, VA

RESEARCH SKILLS

Interviews and Survey Methods
Interviews
Focus Groups
Survey Design
Thematic Analysis
Affinity Mapping

Experimental & Behavioral Methods
Within-Subjects & Between-Subjects Experimental Design
Remote Moderated Usability Testing
Heuristic Evaluation
Stakeholder Walkthrough

Participatory & Co-Design Methods
Participatory Design / Co-Design Facilitation
User Persona Development
Journey Mapping

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Multi-Phase Study Design and Execution
Cross-Institutional Research Collaboration
Research Budget Management
Research Timeline and Milestone Management
Stakeholder Communication and Research Translation

SOFTWARE SKILLS & PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

Minitab
Tableau
Power BI
Qualtrics
Airtable
R/RStudio
LaTeX

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Microsoft Design - Dwyer, H., Basoah, J., & Wang, J. (2026, January 27). When AI joins the team: Three principles for responsible agent design. Microsoft Design. <https://microsoft.design/articles/principles-for-responsible-agent-design/>

DIS 2026 — Basoah, J., Reinecke, K., Rosner, D., & Ogbonnaya-Ogburu, I. F. Hopeful Failure: How Collaborative Design Fiction Reimagines AI.

CSCW 2025 — Basoah, J. et al. Should AI Mimic People? Understanding AI-Supported Writing Technology Among Black Users.

FACCT 2025 — Basoah, J., Chechelnitsky, D., Long, T., et al. Not Like Us, Hunty: Measuring Perceptions and Behavioral Effects of Minoritized Anthropomorphic Cues in LLMs.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

PhD candidate in Human-Centered Design and Engineering at the University of Washington with three consecutive research internships at Microsoft and IBM, including two summers shaping responsible AI strategy at Microsoft. Author of 5 peer-reviewed publications at top-tier venues including FACCT, CSCW, and DIS, with research recognized with a DEI Award for work examining how AI writing tools interact with Black language and identity.

SELECTED INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Microsoft

Design Researcher, Senior Intern | Redmond, WA: June 2026 – September 2026

- Uncovered a previously unrecognized pattern in how users delegate work to AI agents across 3 product lines; revealed critical gaps in control, accountability, and human oversight requirements.
- Finding prompted the Cowork and Scout teams to reprioritize human-in-the-loop interactions and informed new thinking on agent-to-person coordination with Microsoft's future of work researchers.
- Shaped the Q2 product roadmap for Cowork and Scout by translating user research into product requirements for human sign-off, ownership, and intervention in higher-stakes AI workflows.
- Extended work beyond the immediate product teams by contributing research principles to Microsoft's organization-wide human-AI collaboration framework, helping establish scalable boundaries for when AI agents should act autonomously versus defer to people.

Design Researcher, Intern | Redmond, WA: June 2025 – September 2025

- Led foundational research shaping mid- to long-term AI UX strategy for Microsoft's Agent 365 initiative, focusing on risks and design opportunities around personified, agentic AI and AI-powered digital workers.
- Reviewed 30+ academic research papers and public debate on agentic AI; distilled insights into a taxonomy of 14 organizational, group, and individual-level risks.
- Mapped 14 risks to existing and emergent design mitigation tactics; produced a scalable risk-to-mitigation framework adopted into BIC's Responsible AI design strategy.
- Prioritized 3 critical risks for immediate mitigation; partnered with Agent 365 team to prototype design principle cards deployed to AI UX teams across BIC.
- Presented strategic recommendations to BIC's Corporate Vice President, global design organization, and company-wide Aether v-team; shaped responsible deployment of agentic AI across Microsoft 365 and Dynamics ecosystems.
- Findings were adopted by Microsoft's Office of Responsible AI into company-wide policy and governance frameworks for AI agent design, culminating in a co-authored publication on Microsoft Design: When AI Joins the Team: Three Principles for Responsible Agent Design.

IBM Corporation

User Experience Researcher, Senior Intern | Remote: January 2024 – August 2024

- Initiated and implemented a company-wide program spanning 6+ client accounts to identify challenges across multiple clients, with a focus on improving user experience and engagement.
- Drove a 14% UMUX score improvement within 6 months; developed a strategic mixed-methods plan combining usability testing and design critiques to pinpoint and address key friction areas.
- Identified 2 previously unrecognized user segments for IBM z/OSMF through in-depth interviews and usability sessions, expanding the product team's understanding of who their primary users actually were.
- Translated user segment findings into targeted design priorities, directly shaping UI and product feature development roadmap iterations for z/OSMF.

User Experience Researcher, Senior Intern | New York, NY: June 2023 – September 2023

- Analyzed 20+ customer feedback responses bi-weekly during product beta testing; surfaced key highlights and challenges that aligned product development priorities for an upcoming release.
- Distilled 100+ user comments into 5 generative research workshops; sessions surfaced foundational user grievances with product release and shaped product development priorities.
- Oversaw 15+ internal interviews examining impact of 2 distinct visual frameworks on client adoption; derived 7 evidence-based insights feeding directly into exploratory customer research aimed at increasing product adoption.

User Experience Researcher, Intern | Remote: May 2022 – December 2022

- Ran 2 heuristic evaluations of IBM z/OSMF by assessing primary end-to-end user flows across 2 personas; flagged 20 improvement points within user flows.
- Partnered with UX Designer to architect 2 Airtable databases and sponsor user feedback forms; streamlined user experience feedback capture and integration with client feedback processes.
- Administered 6 usability tests on sponsor users alongside UX Designer; built affinity map from results and communicated findings to three-in-a-box team.
- Deployed an on-platform CSAT survey to 200+ z/OSMF users; generated actionable satisfaction and usability data fed directly into product improvement roadmap.